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What Does It Test? Reading Exam Sort

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Instructions

Read the leaflet. Then look at the 21 exam questions. Do not answer them yet. Decide **what each question tests** and write its number in the sorting grid. There are 3 questions for each skill.

The 7 skills

1. **Alphabetical order** – putting words or names in A–Z order, like a dictionary or a list.
2. **Vocabulary** – knowing what a word or phrase means.
3. **Scanning for information** – finding one fact quickly: a time, a date, a number.
4. **Understanding the whole text (gist)** – the main idea, the purpose, who the text is for.
5. **Grammar and punctuation** – verb forms, modal verbs, capital letters, full stops, question marks.
6. **Text type and layout** – what kind of text it is; headings, bullet points, sections.
7. **Reading between the lines (inference)** – working out something the text does not say directly.

Extra task: When you finish sorting, answer the questions.

The text

HACKNEY WINTER HELP DAY

Saturday 7 November, 10am – 3pm Clapton Community Hall, Lower Clapton Road, Hackney

Are you new to Hackney? Do you need help or advice this winter? Come to our free Winter Help Day. Everyone is welcome.

What can you do?

- Get a warm coat or boots for adults and children.
- Talk to a nurse about flu jabs.
- Get advice about doctors, schools and housing.
- Join a free English class for beginners at 11am.

Lunch There is hot soup and bread from 12 to 1pm. It's free!

Please bring your own bag for clothes. Children must stay with an adult.

Last year more than 300 people came. Don't miss it!

For more information, call Amina on 020 7946 0381 or email help@hackneywinter.org.uk

The questions

1. What time does the event finish?
2. Choose the correct word: "Last year, Amina _____ the Help Day too." a) organise b) organises c) organised d) organising

3. Which word comes first in a dictionary? a) clothes b) coat c) children d) class
4. What is the main purpose of this text? a) to sell winter clothes b) to invite people to a free event with help and advice c) to advertise a college English course d) to report on last year's event
5. Why does the writer use bullet points (•)? a) to list the different things you can do there b) to show the start and finish times c) to give the contact details d) to tell a story
6. In the text, "advice" means: a) money b) a doctor c) information about what you should do d) a form to fill in
7. Why do you think the event is in November? a) The weather is getting cold. b) Children are on holiday. c) The hall is cheaper. d) It is a national holiday.
8. These words are from the text. Put them in alphabetical order: soup, advice, nurse, coat
9. When can people eat? a) 10–11am b) 11am–12 c) midday–1pm d) 1–3pm
10. Rewrite this sentence with the correct capital letters and punctuation: the event is at clapton community hall on saturday
11. What type of text is this? a) a letter b) a leaflet c) a story d) a menu
12. Find a word in the text for something you wear on your feet.
13. Who is this text mainly for? a) teachers b) nurses c) people who have recently moved to the area d) shop owners
14. Can a 10-year-old come to the event alone? Yes or No? How do you know?
15. Here are the names of four helpers. Put them in alphabetical order: Yusuf, Amina, Kofi, Dariusz
16. What number can you ring to find out more?
17. "Children must stay with an adult." Which word tells you this is a rule?
18. Choose the best title for the text: a) Cheap Coats for Sale b) A Day of Free Support for Local People c) Hackney Library Opening Times d) How to Book a Flu Jab
19. Which part of the text tells you about food?
20. "Don't miss it!" means: a) Please come. b) Don't come late. c) It isn't important. d) Don't forget your bag.
21. "Last year more than 300 people came." Why does the writer tell us this? a) to show the event is popular and useful b) to say the hall is too small c) to complain about the crowds d) to ask for money

Sorting grid

Write 3 question numbers in each row.

Skill	Question numbers
1. Alphabetical order	
2. Vocabulary	
3. Scanning for information	
4. Understanding the whole text (gist)	
5. Grammar and punctuation	
6. Text type and layout	
7. Reading between the lines (inference)	

Teacher answer key

Skill	Questions	Curriculum focus
1. Alphabetical order	3, 8, 15	Word (Rw)
2. Vocabulary	6, 12, 20	Word (Rw)
3. Scanning for information	1, 9, 16	Text (Rt)

Skill	Questions	Curriculum focus
4. Gist	4, 13, 18	Text (Rt)
5. Grammar and punctuation	2, 10, 17	Sentence (Rs)
6. Text type and layout	5, 11, 19	Text (Rt)
7. Inference	7, 14, 21	Text (Rt)

Answers to the questions

Q	Answer
1	3pm
2	c) organised
3	c) children
4	b
5	a
6	c
7	a
8	advice, coat, nurse, soup
9	c) midday–1pm
10	The event is at Clapton Community Hall on Saturday.
11	b) a leaflet
12	boots
13	c
14	No – children must stay with an adult.
15	Amina, Dariusz, Kofi, Yusuf
16	020 7946 0381
17	must
18	b
19	the section headed “Lunch”
20	a) Please come.
21	a

Words repeated from the text on purpose: Q6 (advice), Q20 and Q21 (quoted phrases), Q17 (quoted rule) and Q8 (word list). These target the word or sentence itself, so paraphrase would defeat the item. Discussion point: Q14 and Q12 can be argued as scanning – worth letting learners debate.